Notes from Volume 1

The Sun:

Derrick Berg (14 years old). He was only introduced in the after credits scene of episode 10, but he's actually really important for later stuff. He comes from the City of Silver, which the clues Klein collects point to its existing in the Forsaken Land that many people had been looking for. His people speak Jotun, an ancient language that was spoken by giants before their extinction (above the gray fog, Klein, a historian proficient in ancient languages, uses the fog for real-time translation, making the others understand Derrick's words), and they worship a being referred to as either "The City of Silver Creator" or "The Ancient Sun", believing he had abandoned them but would return if they were pious enough.

The Forsaken Land is stuck in an eternal darkness, with their only source of illumination being the never-ending lightning storms. They needed to always have lanterns lit as the darkness contained 2 types of danger: monsters that appear all of a sudden, and the dark itself, which caused people who stay a few seconds in it to just disappear as if they were erased from existence.

As a place that was separated from the rest of the world after the Cataclysm in the Second Epoch, the City of Silver preserved a lot of ancient history that the rest of the continents didn't know about. They also carried out explorations of the land but only ever found ruins, believing they were the last humans left alive. They also suffered from a curse: if someone died without being killed by a blood-relative, they would mutate into a dangerous monster. Derrick's first appearance was when he had to kill his parents as they approached the end of their lifespan.

The lack of sunlight and living creatures (other than monsters) meant that they lacked food, with the only edible thing around them being Black-Faced Grass. Other than that, they could eat monster corpses, but too much of it would cause their bodies to become deformed. The people there are also extremely tall, like Derrick is already 1.9 meters or something at this point in the story, with people on the Giant pathway being even taller.

He had only ever read about the sun and the moon in books, so he wanted to be the sun that illuminated the way ahead for his people, protecting them from all danger. That was why he chose The Sun as his tarot card and got the Bard potion formula through the Tarot Club (that's Sequence 9 of the Sun pathway). As the Forsaken land is completely disconnected from the rest of the world, he could only ever exchange knowledge, not materials.

Audrey's friends:

She had a noble friend around her age named Viscount Glaint. They were both deeply interested in mysticism and wanted to become Beyonders, so, when he finally met one, he also introduced her to Audrey. That Beyonder was named Fors Wall, a famous writer who often interacted with the nobles and signed books (a mystery and romance novel she wrote, titled "Stormwind Mountain Villa", gets brought up a lot, everyone in the LOM world has read it), she was a Sequence 9 Apprentice (they could pass through doors and thin walls, she also carried a mystical item that allowed her to teleport a limited number of times, with her being able to gain that ability permanently if she could advance her Sequence).

Fors later introduced Audrey to her friend and roommate, Xio Derecha, a Sequence 9 Arbiter. Xio's family was once considered noble before her father was accused of something and they fell from grace, she had since been investigating with the hopes of mending her father's reputation and providing for her mother and younger brother. The two of them were very involved with Beyonder circles and had a lot of resources that could help Audrey collect ingredients and information.

Qilangos:

This arc started when Alger issued a mission in the Tarot Club to kill this pirate vice-admiral, who possessed a mystical item called Creeping Hunger: it could save and use 1 to 3 of the powers of up to 5 Beyonders that have been "Grazed" by it (their characteristic was devoured, yes the item, which was shaped like a glove, had a mouth). The only powers I currently remember are: one which allows the user to transform into anyone, and I think he had powers similar to a Nightmare, maybe also some from the Spectator pathway.

Qilangos had been preparing to assassinate a noble named Duke Negan, so he snuck into a ball after having changed his appearance. There, he bumped into Audrey who, as a Spectator, noticed small oddities in his behavior (she had previously gotten Xio and Fors to investigate him and his habits), instantly informing The Fool that she may have found Qilangos. Klein then informed The Hanged Man and even sent a letter to Mr. Azik for help. Qilangos was unsuccessful in his mission but, as he tried to run away, he was easily finished by Azik in a terrifying manner. He then left with Creeping Hunger, with Alger arriving alongside the Church of Storms to only find Qilangos' corpse. Audrey, who had saved Duke Negan by warning her father that one of the nobles was acting in an odd manner, received a huge reward, hoping to give part of it to The Fool's "Blessed" who got rid of the pirate.

The emotional outcome of this was that Audrey became very proud that their secret organization had become capable of carrying out missions like that, while Alger was terrified that The Fool had someone this powerful "working under him".

Klein's bank account:

(Yes, this is somewhat significant)

Near the end of Volume 1, Audrey had owed Klein some money. Wanting to keep his identity a secret, he went to a bank that allows for the creation of an anonymous account and set his password as The Fool's Honorific Name. That way, if anyone ever tried anything, he would be able to hear them. Audrey sent the money over and then, not long after, the final battle against Megose happened. Seeing as Klein was only able to rise from the grave without having the chance to retrieve any belongings, it was only thanks to this anonymous bank account and the money he hadn't yet withdrawn that he would be able to start a new life in Backlund.

Volume 2: Faceless

Chapter 214: Land of Hope

In the evening after his stunt as a Clown, Klein arrived using a steam locomotive to Backlund, the most prosperous capital in the Northern and Southern Continents with a population exceeding five million people. One of the city's defining features was its yellow smog indicating the heavy pollution in the air, limiting visibility and obscuring the sun. Klein was even surprised at it only being half past six, stating it looked like it was nine or ten.

He also mentioned the establishment of organizations like the Soot Reduction Association and Smoke Reduction Association, and the passing of a bill stating the need to establish the National Atmospheric Pollution Council.

Klein thought about the fact that not being constantly aware of the exact time made him feel a sense of horror (weirdo, reminds me of myself) which had led him to buy a pocket watch, but instead of a silver one to match his temperament, he opted for a gold one to match the true essence of a Clown: being "showy" and "exaggerated".

He took a sudden turn, causing a person who was tailing him to lose sight of his target (that person was an average thief, idk why I mentioned it since there are no repercussions), then stopped to check the map he had bought. That morning, he had concluded the true essence of a Clown: "Although being capable of knowing a little about fate (as a Seer), one remains helpless towards fate; therefore, one might as well use a smiling face to hide all the pain, sorrow, confusion, and depression."

He could feel a bit of his potion digesting, so he started narrowing down his choices for obtaining his sequence 7 formula: The Secret Order seldom appeared. He could start making contact with local Beyonder circles for clues, or set a trap using his knowledge of the Antigonus family's treasure and that mysterious symbol (shown to him when a puppet opened Tingen's Chanis Gate). The biggest issue was his fear of attracting the attention of the Order's leader, Zaratul, who could even guide Roselle and may or may not still be alive.

After eliminating the areas strongly associated with the Church of Evernight, the poorer districts, and anywhere that would require identification (which, as a recently deceased person, he had no identification), Klein took a second-class seat on a metro to Cherwood Borough. Before the metro set off, he saw an adolescent boy mistakenly take the second-class carriage before apologizing and heading to the third-class one. Not long after, a group of men boarded Klein's carriage, seemingly looking for the boy. Klein ignored them, after all, it was none of his business (for now).

Chapter 215: Mrs. Sammer

Arriving at Minsk Street, Klein found the residence of Stelyn Sammer, who was renting out another Unit she owned. The Madam was in her thirties with blonde hair and blue eyes, her living room was nearly equivalent to the entire Moretti's first floor in area, and from future interactions, I can tell you right now that she loved to brag about her wealth and class. Her husband, Luke Sammer, was a manager at the Coim Company, and a member of the Loen Kingdom's Soot Reduction Association.

Klein introduced himself as Sherlock Moriarty and internally mocked the woman for how many details about her life and family she was willing to share with someone who just did not care. They reached an agreement and he paid a deposit of half a year's rent (she had originally wanted a contract for the entire year, but Klein didn't know when he'd have to abandon everything and be on the run, so he refused), before going to check out his new house. After settling down, he started considering what job he could have: it had to be something lucrative so he wouldn't suffer financially, but it couldn't be something that would restrict him and affect his movements.

He thought of becoming an author by plagiarizing (like Roselle), but his sensitive identity (a dead person) made him wary of becoming famous. He also considered becoming a news reporter, but job applications required documents that he didn't have on hand and had no way of forging for the time being. In the end, he settled on becoming a private detective.

Chapter 216: The Same-old Gathering

Klein posted an advertisement for his identity as a private detective in a newspaper unique to Backlund, as he had no way to offer his services elsewhere. On his way back, he bought various herb powders and silver slices and later prepared all of the mysticism essentials he had to keep on him.

His current plans were to focus on what he could gain from the Tarot Club, along with his own advancement. He could also use his career to get in touch with many different people and slowly find clues regarding the Secret Order. He wouldn't seek out Ince Zangwill yet, as the gap in their powers remained too great for Klein. But if he did run into the man, he wouldn't have minded sending an anonymous letter to the Church. Aside from that, Klein wanted to find a suitable starting business to invest in.

When it was almost time for the Gathering, Klein took four steps counterclockwise and headed above the gray fog, ruminating over the fact that this was one of the few things in his new life that hadn't changed. He warned The Sun Derrick Berg, who was resting while on patrol with his team. The boy found a calm place to sit and pretended to be asleep.

After all three members were summoned, The Hanged Man Alger Wilson said that he had obtained 19 pages of Roselle's diary, but he could only give 6 pages at a time, as that was the limit to his memory. The first was about re-making contact with "that pathetic fellow trapped in the storm": he called himself Mr. Door and promised to fulfill three of the emperor's requests if he helped him escape. Roselle refused to help but listened to the man's teachings about the Fourth Epoch.

Chapter 217: Mr. Door's Description

The page gave insight into the "War of the Four Emperors", which involved the Black Emperor of the Solomon Empire, the half-insane Blood Emperor of the Tudor Dynasty, the Night Emperor of the Trunsoest Empire, and the Emperor of the Underworld of the Southern Continent, also known as Death. Most of the emperors fell one after another, with Death reaping the greatest benefits. He later went mad but also became stronger, teaming up with the Primordial Demoness to bring about a Pale Disaster for the Northern Continent.

It also mentioned the Law of Beyonder Characteristics Indestructibility and the Law of Similar Sequence Beyonder Characteristics Conservation, things Roselle had already learned of in a "most secret and ancient" organization he was part of. He wrote how, if there were too many High-Sequence Beyonders in a pathway, the number of Low-Sequence ones would reduce and vice-versa.

All this information pushed Klein's mind to the bleak conclusion that madness was an inevitability if one lived long enough, causing him to smile to hide the solemnity of his emotions. He turned his thoughts to the Black Emperor whom the original Klein had studied, believing the title to be the name of that pathway's corresponding sequence 1.

He felt that the laws mentioned contradicted reality; as the Churches had many artifacts and High-Sequence Beyonders, while Low-Sequence Beyonders still ran rampant. He wondered if the destruction of the Nation of Evernight could've been a solution when it came to the Evernight pathway, or perhaps certain Sealed Artifacts could have been used for potions.

The second page had Roselle complaining about the pathway he had chosen, noting how it lacked any combat abilities up to Sequence 5 and going into detail about Sequences 9 to 6, comparing them to 7 and 6 of the Mystery Pryer pathway and lamenting over the fact it was incomplete and had a powerful evil being named the Hidden Sage presiding over it.

Chapter 218: Free General Knowledge

The third page had some thoughts about the beginning of the rebellion in Intis and ended on a cliffhanger: Zaratul, the leader of the Secret Order, had come to visit Roselle. But the subsequent pages had nothing to do with this entry, leaving Klein frustrated. The turmoil described reminded Klein of Roselle's death six years after he had declared himself Emperor. The half-historian believed his death hid more than what appeared on the surface, and that it had power struggles between Beyonders behind it, unlike what was taught in textbooks.

The rest of the pages didn't have anything important, the last of them just ended with Roselle sending someone to investigate the Secret Order, with the findings remaining unknown to Klein. Having been done reading, The Fool mentioned the two laws to the members of the gathering, only explaining the first one: Beyonder characteristics can't be destroyed, only passed on. After a Beyonder dies, their characteristic can be used to make a mystical artifact or as the main ingredient of their Sequence's potion, without the supplementary ingredients. Alone, it can be used as a half-mystical object.

Justice Audrey Hall was horrified by this knowledge, but the other two seemed to already know it. As for the explanation of the second law, Klein wasn't going to give it for free.

Chapter 219: Explanation

The Hanged Man, who believed the Fool to be an ancient, powerful entity who recently reawakened and was working to break free of his confines, along with Justice, agreed to help gather information regarding the Secret Order, while the Sun had already been owed from a previous deal.

Klein explained how some pathways are exchangeable at High-Sequences, giving an example of the Death pathway's Sequence 5 being able to advance normally or to the Giant (now known as Gatekeeper) pathway's sequence 4. This reminded Derrick of the City of Silver's former chief, who had retreated into a mausoleum he had built for himself. The young boy suspected he was trying to switch from the Giant pathway to the Death pathway, implying the City of Silver didn't have the subsequent formulas for their sequence 4. Though that chief's complete disappearance implied his failure.

The Fool refused to say what other pathways were exchangeable until information about the Secret Order was collected (he didn't know any more, the readers already should though thanks to the ending of Volume 1). After that was over, Klein asked Audrey and Alger to cooperate with him in an attempt that would help them exchange materials through him, without needing to reveal their real identities to one another.

Chapter 220: Klein's Sacrificial Trial

The Fool described how one side would prepare a sacrificial ritual aimed at him, with the other preparing a bestowment ritual using regular and Beyonder materials as test subjects. The only requirement was for them to draw the symbol he showed them (the one behind his chair), then chanting his name along with a few lines in ancient Hermes or Jotun.

The Hanged Man internally wondered why the Fool was using them for these trials instead of his "Blessed", but he never dared to voice these concerns out-loud, believing that there were secrets he didn't know and that the Fool's Blessed was being monitored. They all agreed to make the attempt as soon as the gathering was over.

Afterwards, Audrey mentioned her knowing of two Beyonders with their own circles and resources in Backlund, believing them to be suitable members for the Tarot Club. Klein hesitated as he had initially wanted his organization's members to remain anonymous so that, if any one of them was ever caught, they wouldn't be able to divulge information about the others, but her mention of Beyonder circles caught his interest.

In the end, he told her that they would need to pass certain "examinations" before joining, but she first had to find a discreet method to get them to recite his Honorific Name (The Fool that doesn't belong to this era, the Mysterious Ruler above the gray fog, the King of Yellow and Black who wields good luck). With the end of that week's gathering, the three members returned to the real world while Klein remained above the gray fog, awaiting the attempt.

Chapter 221: The Tarot Club at a Higher Level

Alger successfully sacrificed the ingredient, growing more fearful at the Fool clearly becoming more and more powerful, though he was consoled by the fact that he was one of the earliest members of their secret organization, so the Fool probably wouldn't cause him any harm once he became strong enough to enter the real world.

Above the gray fog, Klein examined the ingredient in his hand, feeling proud of the success of his idea. He then sent it to Audrey once her ritual was ready. The young noble immediately used the ingredient to prepare her potion and drank it, successfully becoming a Sequence 8 Telepathist.

Returning to the real world, Klein bought gold-rimmed glasses, wigs, and a variety of mustaches, he also rented a small apartment in East Borough, the poorest district of the city, so he would always be ready whenever he needed a disguise or to escape a difficult situation. He spent the next two days experimenting with the gray fog and crafting charms, with his bell finally ringing on Thursday.

Chapter 222: The First Job

The ringing of the bell made Klein worry that clients could come looking for him while he wasn't home, making him lose business. He thought of putting a notice board whenever he went out, or doing a divination at the beginning of every day before deciding to leave. His premonition as a Clown allowed him to see the visitors before he opened the door: they were an old lady and a young man in his twenties.

They were Mrs. Doris and her grandson Jurgen Cooper, a senior solicitor. They lived on the same street as Sherlock Moriarty and had wanted to entrust him the mission of finding her cat, Brody, who had gone missing the previous night. Klein, who was a bit disappointed at his first job being "find a cat", eventually agreed, so he followed them to their home to start gathering clues.

Finding a few strands of black fur, Klein used his cane for Dowsing Rod Seeking. Following the direction it pointed to, he opened a cupboard. The cat was in a cupboard in their house, it never left. When asked how he knew Brody's location, Klein's answer was: "Deduction, my good man."

Returning to his house, he found someone waiting at his front door: it was the adolescent boy from the metro (refer to the end of chapter 214). Being invited inside, the boy introduced himself as Ian, informing Klein that he recognized him as the man who was sizing him up that day. Ian explained that he had been hired by a detective named Zreal Victor Lee to gather information, which led to the scene on the metro.

After that encounter, Zreal disappeared, with his home having indications of being infiltrated. The boy tried reporting the situation to the police, but it hadn't been long enough yet, and other detectives refused the mission, saying they had just seen the man at gatherings. That led him to seek the help of someone unfamiliar to both him and the detective.

Chapter 223: Three Matters

Observing the young boy, Klein reached the conclusion that he had never come into contact with Beyonders or mysticism before, which was why Ian believed that: 1) it couldn't be possible for someone to fool detectives by acting as Mr. Zreal, 2) he was being forced by someone. The task he had for Klein was to just investigate and determine the man's condition, without any further action. They settled on a small payment in advance and Ian owing three favors after the task was done, with the boy promising he'd appear at the right time so the detective won't have to contact him.

As he paid, Klein determined that Ian must suffer from OCD because of the way he carefully arranged the money. The boy left and Klein divined whether the case involved Beyonders. The divination failed to give results.

That night, Klein, disguised as a regular worker, observed Zreal's empty home. He divined that there was danger, but nothing serious. Sneaking in, his Spirit Vision showed three people lying in ambush, he easily dealt with them using a Slumber Charm. Finding some strands of the detective's hair, he prepared to do dream divination, thinking to himself: "Deduction, my good man."

Chapter 224: Mystic-type Detective

In the dream, Klein saw Zreal's rotting corpse (described in detail as always. I might be starting to become numb to these descriptions, idk if this is a good or bad thing) in the sewers, confirming that he had already met his demise. At this point, Klein wasn't disgusted by the sight, he had already seen more corpses than the average human would in 3 lifetimes. Using the materials on him, he forcefully entered the dream of one of the sleeping men.

The target revealed that they had been sent there by a high-ranking member of their gang named Meursault. After being done, Klein cleaned up any traces he left behind, bowed to the three sleeping men, before making his escape through a window, managing to lock it from the outside.

Heading to East Borough, Klein observed how the poor people there looked like living corpses, and how the police in the area treated them harshly. Arriving at his rented apartment, he divined the location of Zreal's corpse before heading there, enduring the smell and the feeling of filth brought about by walking in the sewers. Finding the body that was way too rotten for someone who died only a few days before surrounded by rats munching on it, he failed at channeling the spirit, confirming that the matter involved Beyonders.

Chapter 225: Unnoticeable Guidance

Making sure no one was tailing him, Klein returned to his home in Cherwood Borough. Ian passed by the next morning, surprised that the detective already made progress. He took the boy to the corpse's location, asking him not to mention Sherlock Moriarty's involvement when making a report to the police. With the job being done, Klein's first request was for information about where he could get a gun and some bullets without needing a permit, receiving the answer that he should seek out Kaspars Kalinin at the Bravehearts Bar.

Elsewhere, Audrey was giving Fors Wall and Xio Derecha their reward for the previous mission (I think this was for the Qilangos thing? Can't remember for sure), with the two promising to stay on the lookout for the Spectator and Apothecary formulas for Audrey and Glaint respectively (that was the guy who introduced Audrey to the two, they would search for mysticism-related stuff together).

Noticing some books that Audrey had laid out before their arrival, Xio and Fors asked to borrow them (they didn't know Audrey had put them there deliberately). After arriving home, Xio found a piece of paper in her book that had some "Roselle symbols", before reading the ancient Hermes written at the back of the paper out-loud. It was The Fool's Honorific Name.

Chapter 226: The Terrified Xio

Klein was considering investing in something that was advertised in the newspapers when he heard an illusory voice. Heading above the gray fog, he saw the scene of Xio reading the name on the paper, deciding to only take action deep into the night to probe her reaction.

The woman only realized her mistake after she was done. Waiting in fear for an evil being to find her, she tried to calm herself down when she found no response. When Fors returned, her friend shared the experience with her, leaving the two frightened of this secret existence they had never heard of. They thought of seeking the protection of a church, but as they were of different faiths, that idea was quickly abandoned.

In the middle of the night, Klein went above the gray fog and, after deliberating over the matter for a while, attempted to pull Miss Justice's friend to this other world. When her figure materialized at one of the seats, Xio was only able to get a glimpse of her surroundings before she was sent back. Klein was overjoyed as he confirmed more details about his abilities: he could establish at most one more connection with the current level of his spirituality, and he could pull Beyonders that are at most one Sequence higher than his own, though his success at doing so wasn't guaranteed.

Xio, who wasn't sure whether her very clear dream was brought about due to her fear or whether it was an actual response from "The Fool", decided to get someone to exorcise her at a Beyonder gathering the following day just in case.

Chapter 227: Inventor Leppard

The next morning, Klein, who was missing the varied delicacies he could eat back on Earth, heard a knock on his door. It was Meursault, who had sent the people back at Zreal's home (refer to the middle of chapter 224). He refused to talk inside and plainly stated that he wanted to hire Sherlock Moriarty to find Ian, believing that the detective already knew the boy. Klein first denied that before making it clear that this mission went against his principle of confidentiality, refusing to accept it no matter how high the man raised the price.

After he left, Klein, amidst a light drizzle, headed to the home of a man named Leppard, hoping to invest in the new transportation vehicle he was working on. After signing a non-disclosure agreement, he showed his invention, which he based on some manuscripts left behind by Emperor Roselle, to his potential investor. It was a car that worked with pedals. After explaining why this wasn't something feasible, Klein instead shifted the man's attention to working on a bike, claiming that it would benefit more people like the workers and businessmen.

After the deal was settled, Klein returned home. While looking in the mirror in his bathroom, he saw a pair of eyes to his side.

Chapter 228: The Mastermind

Barely dodging an arrow, Klein fought an immensely powerful black figure. It was thanks to his instincts as a Clown that he was able to dodge most of the attacks, though not without having to tank some of them. A clearer vision of the enemy revealed that it was Meursault, who was both agile and strong. Weakening his attacker by getting him to slam into furniture while also getting weakened by being sent flying through a table, Klein got a hold of a piece of paper and threw it as a projectile that stabbed right through the man's throat.

Observing the damages to the place, he couldn't help remembering that he could no longer claim reimbursement for that before descending into a fit of laughter. It was the only sound that reverberated in the entire house. When he finally calmed down, Klein used a dream to get some answers, finding out that Meursault was sent by the Intis ambassador to bring Ian Wright either alive or recently deceased so his spirit could be channeled. Though the gang-member didn't know why the boy was wanted in the first place.

Finishing his communication with the dead man, Klein collected his Beyonder characteristic before considering what to do with the body.

Chapter 229: Lesser of Two Evils

Klein had three choices: clean up the scene and report this as legitimate self-defense, wait deep into the night and dispose of the corpse, or give up his current identity and flee before changing his name again. Thinking of all downsides to each of these choices, Klein was already inclined towards one of them, but used divination to confirm anyway.

Emptying Meursault's pockets, Klein stabbed a dagger into his throat before hiding anything Beyonder-related above the gray fog to interfere with any attempted divination (the gray fog interferes with divination). When he was done, Klein waited a bit so that by the time the police sent experts to investigate, the deceased's spirit would have already lost the ability to give detailed information. Feeling like a professional at hiding his tracks, Klein compared himself to Moriarty and, after enough time had passed (he was counting the minutes while looking at his pocket watch), found the patrolling officers.

He told them that a criminal had attacked him and that he had accidentally stabbed him to death. When more officers arrived at his home, Klein truthfully gave his (fake) name, his occupation, proof he was renting this house, along with explaining the situation with Ian, Zreal, and Meursault's gang. He even claimed to have tailed the man and found him talking to someone he addressed as "Mr. Ambassador", saying that he knew how he looked but not his name.

Claiming his faith with the Church of Steam in order not to encounter the Nighthawks, Klein followed them to the police station.

Chapter 230: Interrogation

In a Beyonder gathering, Xio was finally able to purchase the Sequence 8 Sheriff potion formula, she also set up a notice of a reward for someone skilled in exorcism. A believer of the sun responded, attempting a purification ritual. Klein, who was at the police station, was amused as he felt a strange warmth just as

the cold of the cell was starting to seep into his body. Encouraging himself with the thought that matters regarding an ambassador would garner much more attention than a “puny” detective such as himself, and remembering the fact that he hid all signs of Beyonder involvement in his battle with Meursault, he waited until he was called to the interrogation room.

As soon as he sat down and the man opposite him started speaking, the oppressive force surrounding Klein made him immediately realize that he was talking to a Beyonder: A Sequence 7 Interrogator from the Arbiter pathway. He was made to identify the ambassador from a bunch of photographs before repeating what he knew about Ian Wright and assuring the Interrogator that everything he said was the truth.

After he was allowed to leave, Klein was taken to fill out some forms with the help of Jurgen Cooper (his neighbor whose grandmother has a cat), who had come to bail him out.

Chapter 231: Losses

Klein paid the bail and was informed by Jurgen that he could come back for the money after the case was closed, but calculating his overall losses because of the damages to his home left him worried about his finances if he didn’t get back the bail. On their way back, the two agreed to work together in the future, starting with the contract for Klein’s bike investment.

As soon as he got home, he was invited by his neighbors who were also his landlords, Mr. and Mrs. Sammer. After he apologized for the mess, his hosts started inquiring about the situation (his answer was that it may have been a thief), before shifting their curiosity towards how much a private detective could earn. That led to Mrs. Sammer going on and on about what is considered a decent income and how one could live comfortably, and Klein found out that the Coim company Luke Sammer works at is specialized in anthracite and charcoal. The mention of her husband’s job got the woman to get back to her flaunting of their wealth. Klein was glad he at least didn’t have mean landlords.

He later decided to head to the Bravehearts bar, which Ian had mentioned, in the hopes of hiring a powerful Beyonder bodyguard for two reasons: taking advantage of his situation to come into contact with other Beyonders, and because he was genuinely afraid the ambassador would send someone more powerful next time. If the price was too high though, he thought of just blowing the copper whistle to get Mr. Azik’s help. Thinking about his situation, Klein found it comical that he, a Sequence 8 Beyonder, a vengeful evil spirit back from the dead, needed a bodyguard (he was really overestimating Sequence 8, and he considered himself an “evil” spirit? He had yet to experience the true cruelty of this world).

Chapter 232: The Bravehearts Bar

Back at the Beyonder gathering, the person who sold the Sheriff formula to Xio asked to speak to her in private and, after some deliberation, she agreed, though not before disguising herself completely. The man revealed that he also possessed the ingredients she would need, and that he came from a powerful organization that wanted to make a deal with her so their more “secretive” missions could be carried out by a bounty hunter instead. After making sure that she had the right to refuse any mission she found unsuitable for her, Xio agreed to the partnership.

As for Klein, he busied himself with buying replacements for everything that had been destroyed at his home, then he went to the bar to find Kaspars Kalinin with the code Ian had given him. He successfully purchased a revolver along with fifty rounds and asked about hiring a bodyguard that "exceeded human limitations." Klein was sent to meet the man so that he could determine the danger of the mission before responding.

When entering the room, Klein used his Spirit Vision to find out that the Beyonder was playing cards with a bunch of zombies.

Chapter 233: A Man Cannot Be Judged By His Looks

Acting as if he didn't notice anything, Klein told the man, named Maric, that he had "offended a big shot who might have a country supporting him". He was immediately kicked out. Seeing as this was the strongest Beyonder Kaspars knew, Klein just asked him to keep an eye out as he started to consider how he could deal with the matter all on his own.

Considering the fact that the ambassador's target was Ian, Klein had the idea that he could shake him off by making it clear that he didn't know the boy's whereabouts. But after what happened, he couldn't be sure that his enemy wouldn't want to take revenge, which could be easily done by mentioning the fact that Meursault was a Beyonder, putting Sherlock Moriarty, who was able to kill him, in a difficult situation. Just thinking about all that made him have a strong desire to just kill the ambassador. Such an action wouldn't bring him any psychological burden, as the other was the one who sent someone to kill Klein first. He also considered setting this as a mission for the Tarot Club.

Using dream divination, he was able to see the room Ian was in, but he was unable to pinpoint his exact location. The boy had even refused to leave anything with Klein, making it impossible to find him. Finally heading above the gray fog, he didn't get a different answer, so he instead cast his sight onto a newly added crimson star. Touching it, he could see the scene of the exorcism Xio had attempted, and he was even able to watch the rest of the gathering all the way until Xio and Fors returned home before the "recording" came to an end.

Chapter 234: The Night of the Full Moon

Continuing to divine more about Ian, Klein reached the conclusion that him and Zreal hid some secrets and had an organization behind them. He then rummaged through the things he had previously hidden close to the seat of the Fool and found Meursault's Beyonder characteristic. Using divination, he found out that the gang-member was a Sequence 9 Hunter who had received the potion from the ambassador in exchange for helping him find an important item.

Leaving a note on his desk where he wrote that he didn't know Ian's whereabouts but left a clue that came from the scenes he had seen above the gray fog, Klein went to sleep. Deep into the night, a Full Crimson Moon appeared, resulting in Fors waking up in pain with confusing murmurings ringing in her head, along with layers of light and shadows filling her vision. She barely made it through until everything was over, but she suspected that the next time that happened, she might lose control.

The next morning, Klein found the note on his desk had moved during the night, leaving him terrified at the fact that he hadn't sensed an intruder and could have easily been disposed of. The fact that the paper wasn't returned to its original position was probably a form of warning, but Klein's continued existence may have also meant that the intruder didn't want to alert the military who were monitoring the area. Using divination to determine if someone sneaked into his room, he obtained a negative result: either someone or something interrupted him, or the one who sneaked in wasn't human.

Chapter 235: The Busy Monday

Pretending as if nothing happened, Klein left the paper so that the military, who would definitely be monitoring him, would find it later. He then went out, as he had an appointment with lawyer Jurgen. Brody the cat was the one who opened the door, then the two men discussed the details of the investment contract before being called to breakfast by the lawyer's grandmother.

After breakfast, Klein headed to Leppard's to sign the contract before heading to the public library where he found out the name of the Intis ambassador: Bakerland Jean Madan. Not long before three, he was above the gray fog divining his situation; he found that the military had relaxed their surveillance on him, and the infiltrator the previous night seemed to be a black worm who was sent under Bakerland's orders.

At three, the Tarot Gathering began as usual, with Justice Audrey, who had become a Sequence 8 Telepathist, greeting everyone, after which The Hanged Man Alger handed in another 6 pages of Roselle's diary. Before The Fool Klein started reading, the blue-haired man reported that he had found some information about the Secret Order: they had ties to Intis. This wasn't surprising to Klein, as he already knew their leader's involvement with Roselle (back in Volume 1, Zaratul was mentioned in some diary entries. He was the one the emperor was talking about when he said that Seers are annoying and their speech is vague. Roselle had also said that he would punch every Seer he would meet, making Klein glad the man was already resting in peace).

Chapter 236: Internal Commission

Klein had been setting up The Fool's character traits as someone who was very powerful but was restricted for some reason, he was not omnipotent nor omniscient, and he could be put into tough situations not unlike what was mentioned in The Book of Storms or The Revelation of Evernight. This made it so that the Tarot members wouldn't be suspicious if there were things he didn't know or if he occasionally asked for help. This all relied on the fact that he had already showcased his possession of powerful "Blessed" when Mr. Azik finished off Qilangos.

Keeping that in mind, The Fool issued a mission that was "inconvenient" for another "Blessed" of his to do himself, and they could choose whether to accept it or not: the assassination of the Intis Republic ambassador to the Loen Kingdom, Bakerland Jean Madan. The members of the gathering had different reactions: Audrey was worried about the conflict that could arise between the two countries, Alger had confirmed his suspicions that The Fool's influence on the real world was currently limited, and Derrick was confused as to what all of those words meant.

Noticing Justice's hesitation, The Hanged Man mentioned how the ambassador was suspected to be a Beyonder, and how he supported bloodshed and planned multiple incidents. He also convinced her that no war would start just because of the death of a diplomat; that only depended on whether both sides wanted to fight. This information made her hesitation vanish as she no longer felt like she would be killing an innocent man, causing her to accept the mission. She was hoping to delegate it to her two Beyonder friends, Xio and Fors. Alger also accepted the mission, claiming that he might be able to do it despite not being in Backlund. Klein then turned his attention to the diary in his hands.

Chapter 237: Sequence 2

In the first two pages, Roselle found out that the leader of the Secret Order, Zaratul, was a Sequence 2 Miracle Invoker of the Seer pathway. He also learned from him that fate was only part of the Seer pathway, not its main focus, and that the one representing fate was the Monster pathway, giving examples from it: Sequence 7 Lucky, Sequence 5 Winner, Sequence 2 Soothsayer, and Sequence 1 Snake of Mercury, also known as Snake of Fate. The Monster pathway was controlled by a secret organization known as the Life School of Thought, who also controlled the Apothecary pathway. They worshiped the moon but not the Evernight, which he found confusing.

This information made Klein realize that fate shouldn't be his focus while trying to digest his potions, otherwise, his "acting" for subsequent Sequences might fail. The third page was focused on the creation of the steam engine, so he quickly turned to the fourth page. In it, Roselle had learned the details of how Beyonder characteristics can be passed down to children. Thinking about the Law of Beyonder Characteristic Indestructibility, Klein wondered where the first characteristics came from, but he had no answer for the time being.

The fifth page was focused on pop music and the novels Roselle plagiarized, such as the Count of Monte Cristo. The final page recounted the transmigrator's meeting with a man from the Black Emperor pathway along with his son, Nast Solomon, whose name Klein found familiar: he was a pirate currently know as The King of the Five Seas, meaning that he had been alive for almost 160 years. Once The Fool was done reading the pages, Audrey asked Derrick for information regarding dragons, as he had once referred to the Spectator pathway as the Dragon pathway. He agreed and wanted, in exchange, the Sequence 8 formula for the Bard pathway.

Chapter 238: Dragon of Imagination

Klein interrupted, saying that he could provide The Sun with the Light Suppliant formula (he had gotten all the Sun pathway formulas up to Sequence 4 back in Volume 1 when he gazed at the Blazing Sun through divining 3-0782), with her repaying him later if his "Blessed" needed help. He gave the young boy the formula before isolating the Hanged Man's senses so the other two could speak privately, just as Audrey had requested. Derrick then described the Giant King's enemies, rulers of the sky: the dragons (they looked like typical western dragons). They had many different abilities, with the most common among them being the mind dragons (from whom the Spectator pathway stemmed), whose representative was Dragon King Ankewelt, the Dragon of Imagination. He had a son, Alzuhod, the Dragon of Nightmare, and whatever he imagined would manifest and become reality. This ability reminded Klein of Sealed Artifact 0-08.

The Dragon of Nightmare could control the heart of any living creature, making them believe that their actions were of their own will. It could also fabricate real nightmares into reality, and even create coincidences to push the fates of living creatures into tragedy. This also brought Klein's mind back to his experience with 0-08. The dragons were later defeated by the City of Silver's Creator when he awoke, which contradicted the history Klein and Audrey knew. With the noble lady being satisfied with the information she had received, the gathering continued for some time before the members were sent back to the real world.

She got a letter from her elder brother, Alfred, who was in the Southern Continent, stating that he had found two of the creature she had previously written to him about. But they were useless to her by then, as she had already advanced (she had needed them as potion ingredients).

Chapter 239: Each Having Their Own "Gathering"

Thinking how every "famous detective" needed a good assistant, Audrey decided to use one these creatures for her dog, Susie's next potion, and exchange the other if she needed ingredients. She then recounted her debt to The Fool so far: intelligence regarding the Secret Order, assassinating the Intis ambassador, and a request from his Blessed. She decided to start with collecting information about ambassador Bakerland through high society balls before delegating the mission.

Meanwhile, the connection between the Secret Order and Intis led Klein to speculate that whoever had snuck into his room was a member of the Order, or at least someone with a connection to them which allowed him to get the formulas for the Seer pathway. That also explained why his Clown's premonition ability didn't trigger that night: Beyonders can cause a suppression effect on others on the same pathway who are of a lower Sequence. It would also make sense why that worm's timing and target (the note) was so perfect: a Seer could easily divine that. A higher Sequence Beyonder of the Seer pathway who could control a worm? Klein was amused as he thought of another circus worker: a Beast Tamer.

Remembering the revelation he had received at the end of Volume 1 (Backlund was the answer to his following advancements), he began considering what to do next. He suspected that the ambassador might not send anyone for him. But if he did, it might be that Seer pathway Beyonder who was at least Sequence 7, maybe even 6 or 5. Klein's plan settled on: keep heading to the bar to find a suitable bodyguard, and try to sell Meursault's Beyonder characteristic.

He ate, then, by summoning himself and responding to himself (the method he used in episode 5 of Volume 1), he brought back some things from above the gray fog such as; Azik's copper whistle, Meursault's characteristic, his self-made charms, some materials, and his deck of tarot cards, leaving behind the bloodied paper he had stabbed into the intruder's neck.

Heading to the Bravehearts bar, Klein was glad he hadn't brought the copper whistle with him back when he met Maric; as his zombies would have most probably mutated on the spot and would have "come to entertain Klein warmly" as he put it. He met Kaspars, who said he would introduce him to a place where strong people gather and make deals, giving the young detective a mask before taking him to the location where of that gathering. After internally grumbling about the price that the arms dealer asked for, Klein paid, put on the mask and a long, hooded robe, and went in.

Inside, there was a lone candle on a table, and surrounding it were about ten people sitting on different furniture. When the gathering started, a man was asking for help with some wild beasts in the sewers that kept eating his herbs while ignoring the poisonous ones. And, as he was only good at concocting medicines, not fighting monsters, he couldn't get rid of them himself.

Chapter 240: Trying Your Luck?

The man's words made Klein guess that he was an apothecary, and that he may have been a member of the Life School of Thought secret organization or a believer of Earth Mother (that church had the Planter and Apothecary pathways, with the latter being apparently incomplete), though he couldn't ignore the possibility of the man being an unaffiliated Beyonder. In Loen, apart from the main churches (Evernight, Storm, and Steam), only Earth Mother was allowed to exist in the Kingdom, as there were issues with the other orthodox churches. But the Earth didn't have enough believers for there to be a Beyonder team, and even if they did form one, it wouldn't be recognized by the government (Evernight had the Nighthawks, Storm had the Mandated Punishers, and Steam had the Machinery Hivemind).

The suspected Apothecary stated his price: four bottle of specially concocted medicine and even added some money when no one responded. A man accepted under the witness of Eye of Wisdom, the convener of this gathering who seemed to be an elderly gentleman. After a few deals succeeded and others failed, Klein, acting clueless, as if he didn't understand the value of what he had in his hands, tried selling the characteristic that he thought was "very magical". He relied on the fact that there must be others aware that this could be used as the main ingredients of a potion, as he wasn't going to benefit these random people with such precious knowledge. He was also probing to see if anyone there was powerful enough to know, and acting as if he didn't understand mysticism. After all, while these people didn't know his identity, Kaspars did, and being "careful" and "prudent" were essential for Klein.

The Eye of Wisdom offered a price that, according to Klein's experience, was very reasonable. He was able to recognize the item's Sequence number just by looking at it, making Klein suspect that he was a Sequence 7 Appraiser. Accepting the deal, the disguised detective asked for a bodyguard instead of the money, stating that he had offended someone who should be at Sequence 6 or 5.

"Sequence 6, maybe Sequence 5? Why don't you just die quietly? If we reached that level, why would we be attending such a small gathering?" Was the Apothecary's response. Eye of Wisdom then calmly explained that in the Beyonder world, people at that level were very, very powerful and terrifying (this sounds so silly to me, someone who has experienced actual terror in the later volumes). Even a mystical item equivalent to the price Klein was about to receive wouldn't be enough, so the elder's only advice was for him to apologize to the person he offended and try to buy his understanding.

One of the people in the gathering then offered to sell a mystical item he had: it could let him hear the voice of a great being, and he could try his luck; either gaining useful information (10% chance), a curse, or being hurt with the possibility of dying. Hearing that, Klein guessed that the item was left behind after the death of a Listener from the Aurora Order. Deciding to try using it above the gray fog, severely reducing the negative side effects, Klein accepts the deal.

Chapter 241: Language of Foulness

"Why don't you leave an address? That way, I can get something out of your body." (I'm including the Apothecary's quotes because I find the contrast funny between Klein, who's constantly mocking people in his mind, and him, who mocks people to their face. How the man has survived to this day eludes me).

Klein's explanation for his choice was that not doing anything meant certain death, while taking a risk with this mystical item had a sliver of a chance to work. "I admire you. In the past, I had quite a few friends who had such characters. Now, I visit their tombstones every year and place a bunch of flowers there," the suspected Apothecary mused in a mocking but actually persuasive manner.

Klein gave the Beyonder characteristic and in turn the man slid a small box towards him. As soon as his hands touched the box, Klein heard illusory sounds that made him dizzy. They weren't difficult to bear though, as he had been used to similar murmurings whenever the Tarot members would use his Honorific Name. He examined the item inside the box before being told that he had to touch it without gloves to use it. Once they were done and the gathering ended, people started leaving in order through different exits.

After returning to his home, Klein made sure there was no one around before taking the new mystical item above the gray fog, which blocked the illusory sounds he could previously hear from it, making him much more confident in his following attempt. But it was completely isolated, so he didn't hear anything even after touching it. Convincing himself this wasn't nearly as dangerous as directly looking at the Blazing Sun, he decided to divine the origin of this item.

In the dream, he heard an extremely evil voice that immediately woke him up, but even covering his ears wasn't enough as the voice kept echoing in his head. His body started mutating as the gray fog swayed and tentacles started growing out of him (yes, this will be significant). But this time, he didn't fall to the ground and barely endured the pain. The situation wasn't out of his control, so he was able to quickly recover once the ravings stopped, noting that the True Creator seemed to be surprisingly stronger than the Blazing Sun.

The item in his hands shattered and, combining it with the tentacles that had fallen off his body, a black charm was formed. Using divination, Klein confirmed that this charm could make his opponent hear terrifying sounds and be affected with madness. If said opponent was weak, they would die, otherwise they might benefit but at the cost of becoming a believer of the True Creator. He decided to call the charm Language of Foulness.

Chapter 242: Bakerland

Early Tuesday morning, Klein received a visit from his neighbor, Mrs. Sammer, and a friend she introduced as Mary Gale, a shareholder of the Coim company. Mary needed the detective's help in tailing her husband to confirm if he had a mistress, hoping to obtain material evidence. For that, she would lend him a portable camera, as the picture taken could be used in court to put her husband at a disadvantage. She then provided him with detailed information about the man and his regular activities.

Elsewhere, violin tunes were playing as exquisitely-dressed men and women danced. Amidst them, Audrey "accidentally" bumped into the Intis ambassador. They talked a bit about the differences between Loen and Intis before he left (he was such a disgusting pervert, I'll spare you from his speech).

Kance, a friend of Audrey's who was in MI9 (a Beyonder organization belonging to the military instead of a church), warned her not to get involved with that awful man, giving her the chance to gather more information about Bakerland. She learned that he was a Sequence 6 Conspirer of the Hunter pathway and had a shadow assistant who may have reached Sequence 5. After their chat, the noble girl went to meet Xio and Fors.

Chapter 243: Catching the Adulterous Act

Klein, who was sitting opposite the Coim Company, wore glasses that didn't provide nay vision correction as he enjoyed a Desi pie that contained meat and apples along with some iced tea. He compared Backlund to Tingen; the former was a big city, the capital, so food of all styles could be found there. There were also all kinds of operas and plays available, even if he wasn't willing to spend so much money on entertainment.

He had been sitting there since eight in the morning, as Mary had told him that someone had divulged to her that her husband would leave the office on Wednesday and Friday mornings and only return in the afternoon. He would also leave work early two days a week, even though she had never seen him return home before seven. More than an hour later, his target, Doragu Gale, walked out of the company and waited for a carriage. Klein took that chance to bump into the man, slipping a spare button of his into the target's coat pocket; that would give him the chance to find him using divination.

Arriving at the Quelaag Club, Klein was stopped at the door, as only members were allowed inside. And, to become a member, one had to be recommended by two people who were already members. Not giving up, he left and got a short-stay hotel room near the club before heading above the gray fog. There, he used dream divination to get a clear vision of the woman that Doragu met, deciding to tail her later to find out her name and address. He also took the chance to divine whether the worm that had infiltrated his room was under the control of a Beyonder from the Seer pathway, receiving a positive answer. Having expected the divination to fail, Klein was really surprised. He surmised that the gray fog might have some relation to the Seer pathway, making it able to fill in the necessary details for a successful divination about it.

Having confirmed that the Beyonder accompanying the ambassador was of his same pathway, Klein felt like he finally had a lead to his Sequence 7 and maybe even Sequence 6 potion formulas. Meanwhile, Audrey informed Xio and Fors that she needed their help to assassinate the Intis ambassador to the Loen Kingdom, Bakerland Jean Madan.

Chapter 244: Appointee

After the initial surprise, Xio stated that this mission was above their level. Audrey clarified that she wasn't asking them to assassinate him themselves, just to find someone in their circles who could. They agreed and immediately contacted the convener of a Beyonder gathering, Mr. A (this naming convention is popular among the oracles of the Aurora Order). He said that he could do it, but he wanted to raise the price or to obtain some potion formulas, even if they were incomplete. After confirming Audrey's agreement to the new price, they went back to him to settle the deal.

Later, Klein met Mary Gale again, informing her of the name and address of her husband's mistress, showing her a picture he took of her leaving the Quelaag club. He also informed her of his inability to follow them inside as he wasn't a member. She told him that she could get two members to nominate him and that she would even pay the initial fees for him joining the club.

After dinner, he headed back to the Bravehearts bar for two reasons: acting helpless so the military secretly monitoring him wouldn't discover that he was a Beyonder, and convincing the Seer pathway Beyonder, who would most likely also pay attention to his actions, that he was grasping at straws and was still searching for a way to defend himself. That way, he could surprise that Beyonder with the Language of Foulness charm.

He found that Maric had been looking for him, but he wasn't accompanied by his zombies this time. He informed Klein that he had a friend more powerful than him who was willing to take the job of protecting him for three days but for a high price. Wanting to divine whether that friend was trustworthy, Klein asked for a few days to consider it and save up some money, assuring Maric that he would need those three days sometime during the following two weeks.

The Seer following him would definitely be aware of his bodyguard, but this would at least divert their attention from his own preparations. As for the large sum of money needed to hire the bodyguard, Justice Audrey already owed him some money along with intelligence regarding the Secret Order. Together, that would be enough.

Chapter 245: Confirmation

Back home, Klein heard an illusory voice that he could determine to be from a woman, but he was in no hurry to head above the gray fog and instead acted as if nothing had happened. It was only a while later that he locked himself in the bathroom and took four steps counterclockwise. He found Justice had reported to him everything she had found out about the Intis ambassador, along with Mr. A's conditions for taking on the mission. Klein guessed that Mr. A was a Sequence 5 Shepherd of the Secrets Suppliant pathway, or at least a Rose Bishop, and that he was likely one of the Aurora Order's 22 oracles.

The formulas he had wanted were: Unshadowed, Cataclysmic Interrer, Prophet, or Manipulator. The former two seemed to be from the Sun and Sailor pathways respectively, while the third could have belonged to Knowledge and Wisdom, but Klein had no guesses for the fourth. This implied that these pathways were interchangeable with Secrets Suppliants at higher sequences, but he remained doubtful as 5 pathways that could be swapped together was just too much.

Klein then turned to divining whether it was safe for him to hire Maric's friend as a bodyguard, receiving the answer that she was reliable. After using divination to also confirm that Bakerland's life will be threatened by Mr. A, he replied to Audrey, telling her that she made the right choice while warning her of interacting with Mr. A too much, and asking her to send some money to his blessed as she had previously done to settle her debts to The Fool.

On Thursday, Mary introduced Klein to two people who were willing to recommend the detective to the Quelaag club; they were a surgeon named Aaron Ceres and an aristocratic equestrian teacher named Talim Dumont.

Chapter 246: Strange Omen

After paying the fees and obtaining his proof of membership, Klein was informed of the club's features: a buffet cafeteria, bar, library, squash room, conference room, card room, and many lounge rooms. He took a tour of the place before heading into a lounge room for an "afternoon nap". As he was making plans for obtaining evidence of Doragu's affair the following day, his body tensed up from his Clown's premonition, but he couldn't see any scenes.

Taking four steps counterclockwise, he divined that he would be in grave danger within the next few days. But he was still confused as to how he could sense that in the first place; usually, his abilities only allowed him to predict danger when a target was right in front of him. He rushed over to the Bravehearts bar where he met Maric, informing him that he accepted the deal and that the three days of protection should start immediately. He told Klein that she had agreed and that she had started to protect him in a hidden way, even using his Spirit Vision didn't allow Klein to see any signs of his bodyguard.

Returning home, Klein was looking in the bathroom mirror before his reflection suddenly changed: he could see a woman dressed in black, with blond hair and blue eyes. He didn't hide his surprise as she bowed at him before disappearing, only then did he realize that she may have been Maric's friend.

Chapter 247: The Whole Story

Klein found it weird that she seemed to be a ghost, or some sort of undead creature, but she wasn't affected by Azik's copper whistle, which he was carrying with him. He also remembered how none of the corpses had become zombies back when he was buried in the cemetery. This made him decide to further investigate the whistle's abilities later. Hearing the doorbell ring, Klein opened the door to find Ian Wright, who had come to apologize for involving him in all of these dangerous matters. Letting the boy in, the two sat together so he could explain everything, with the ghost sitting somewhere within Klein's eyesight, but not Ian's.

It turned out that Detective Zreal was a spy for the Feysac Empire, and that Ian was one of the children he had trained to gather intelligence. Recently, he had stumbled upon information regarding a manuscript left behind by a great scientist known as Turani von Helmosuin. After reporting that to Zreal, the detective's home was infiltrated and Ian asked for Sherlock Moriarty's help. Having confirmed the Feysacian spy's death, the boy contacted his superiors but was ambushed when he went to meet them. He was barely able to escape and immediately came to Klein's house.

Reflecting on the situation, Klein found that he had made two mistakes: the first was that he still accepted the mission even when he thought it ran deeper than it seemed, and didn't even flinch or reveal any information when Meursault had come looking for him. The second mistake was that he accepted the mission using Sherlock Moriarty's name and even used his home as his office, making it impossible for him to run away, otherwise the ambassador could easily leak the information of him being a Beyonder, which would cause the officials to focus on investigating him.

Once they began investigating Sherlock Moriarty, it wouldn't be long before they realized that he was a resurrected Klein Moretti. *I'm really like a Clown, with one mistake triggering a chain reaction, only to*

result in a desperate attempt to balance myself so as to please the audience... The safest solution for him was the death of the ambassador along with his Sequence 5 assistant.

Chapter 248: Waiting From Both Sides

After Ian left, Klein informed his bodyguard that he was a Beyonder, claiming that he had benefited greatly from the dangerous item he had bought at the gathering Kaspars had brought him to. This sentence was technically true, as he had obtained the Language of Foulness charm, he just said it in a way that implied it had made him a Beyonder. Hearing his doorbell again, Klein was confused when he found it to be a police sergeant.

Elsewhere, Bakerland was attending a ball while waiting for the team he had sent to obtain the manuscript, and for someone he referred to as "Rosago" to kill the detective who had leaked information to MI9. When the ambassador had gone to a more secluded space, a lady tried to ambush him but he easily retaliated, demanding to know who had sent her.

Chapter 249: The Assassination

Before she could answer, her body was torn apart as a figure crawled out of it. This was flesh and blood magic that Sequence 6 of the Secrets Suppliant pathway, a Rose Bishop, excelled at. It allowed them to hide inside the bodies of others, but once they emerged, the host would die. Bakerland tried to call for help, but the room was isolated and no one could hear him. Using an ancient book with the incantation "I came, I saw, I record", Mr. A was able to use many Beyonder powers to kill the ambassador before running away.

Back at Klein's home, he didn't have enough time to head above the gray fog for a divination, so all he could do was to divine whether his visitor was dangerous in the real world. He obtained a negative result, but he still didn't let his guard down, as a Seer of a higher sequence than him could easily interfere with his divination. Opening the door, he was informed by the sergeant to be careful of strangers for the following two days.

Chapter 250: Rich Experience in Courting Death

The two walked in to discuss further arrangements, as the higher-ups had arranged three options for Sherlock Moriarty: The first was to spend two days in the Wind Cathedral, as it was the closest. Before he could tell him the second choice, Klein's vision blurred and his thoughts became sluggish, with the world around him feeling like it was slowing down. His experiences reminded him of Sealed Artifact 2-049, the Antigonus family's puppet, which had had a similar effect on him.

The Antigonus family wielded control of the Seer pathway, meaning that this must have been the mid-sequence Seer Beyonder Klein had been expecting. The man introduced himself as Rosago and expressed his surprise at Klein's ability to hire such a powerful bodyguard. Klein was confused as to why that Seer kept talking while trying to control both him and the ghost instead of just killing directly, but that gave him the chance to activate the Language of Foulness charm.

As soon as he did, evil whispers started to spread out, and Rosago's control over the two weakened, allowing their movements to return to normal. Klein, who was used to hearing ravings often, endured the madness and pain as he threw the charm at Rosago. Both he and the blond woman fell to the ground from the pain, but their state wasn't as bad as the Seer who was tearing at his own flesh. Being the first to recover, Klein took out his revolver, pressed it against his opponent's temple, and fired five rounds successively.

After making sure that Rosago was dead, he threw a Slumber Charm at his bodyguard, mocked himself (*"It's also good to court death often. At least I gained some immunity."*), but he didn't dare attempt mediumship in the real world, as Rosago's soul was definitely tainted by the True Creator's ravings. Instead, he pulled the man's remaining spirituality above the gray fog, asking him about the potion formulas for the Seer pathway.

Chapter 251: Gains

He first heard a warning Rosago had once received:

"Divination is a revelation, a result; it is unable to tell us the process. For example, you might decide to invest all your money because your divination says that a railway stock can make money. But in fact, what that revelation really means is that in the long run, in thirty years, the railway stock will make money, and before that, it will fall more than it rises. Fate isn't so easy to master, and there are many times when it's impossible to quantify it. Divination isn't all-powerful. In addition, divination can be interfered with and cause you to be misled. There are too many things in this world that cannot be understood. If you completely rely on divination, then you'll definitely die because of it. Divination is a revelation. It must be combined with one's own carefulness, caution, and self-control."

Then, he saw the formula for the Seer pathway's Sequence 7 potion; Magician and Sequence 6; Faceless. He heard another warning: *"According to my experience, after you consume the Faceless potion, you have to remember this point—you can disguise yourself into anyone, but you are ultimately yourself."*

From Sequence 5 and higher, a potion couldn't just be consumed; it required a ritual. The Sequence 5; Marionettist's ritual was to drink the potion while a nearby mermaid was singing. As soon as he saw all the ingredients, Klein stopped holding out and was forced back into the real world; he had expended too much of his spirituality and was reaching his limit.

Taking a moment to breathe, his spirituality was just starting to recover when his bodyguard woke up. Klein's explanation for the Slumber Charm was that he was nervous and panicked when Rosago's body kept squirming, so he threw out all the charms he had on him. He also explained to her how the mystical item he had bought had shattered, forming the Language of Foulness Charm.

When she was satisfied with his answers, they started going through the things Rosago had on him and dividing them among themselves; she took a mystical item corresponding to a Notary (a Sequence 6 or 5 of the Bard pathway), while he took the contaminated Beyonder characteristic; a black, pupilless eye. Using this characteristic as the main ingredient for a Marionettist potion was equivalent to committing suicide by ingesting poison, so he would have to find a way to purify it first.

Chapter 252: Epilogue

As soon as he touched the characteristic, Klein heard illusory sounds that gave him a headache, but he also saw countless illusory black threads that emanated from his and the woman's bodies, reaching up into the void. Putting the eye in a small iron box, his head cleared once again, and he determined that these threads must have been the essence of a Marionettist's powers, and what allowed one to control a person's body and spirit.

After she took some materials and he took the money Rosago had on him, they focused their attention on cleaning up the scene. The ghost-like lady fused herself with the body, made it stand up as all of its blood flowed back into it, before walking out through the front door. After she left, Klein used divination and found out that Bakerland had already died, meaning that he could finally relax.

A while later, his bodyguard appeared in the reflection of a window. He thanked her and was talking about finishing his payment with Maric when she insisted on finishing the contract and protecting him for three days, as that was what he had paid for. Klein was just glad that her protection would end on Sunday, not affecting the following Tarot Gathering. Asking how he should address her, she replied with "You don't need to know" before disappearing.

Chapter 253: Night Thoughts

Feeling too uneasy to take a bath with Miss Bodyguard around, Klein just collapsed into his bed. Despite his exhaustion, he was too tense to sleep, so he decided to unfurl his thoughts. His fear of coincidences thanks to 0-08 made him worry about how his second case since coming to Backlund led to his acquisition of the following three potion formulas, but thinking of everything that got him to this point, he felt like it was all reasonable and could have happened without any external influences.

Connecting Klein's death – which was caused by the Antigonus family's notebook, a family that controlled the Seer pathway – with Roselle regrets – he didn't choose to become a Seer, Apprentice, or Marauder – it seemed like Klein attracted and was attracted to things related to the Seer pathway, and that special characteristic of his was probably the reason he was able to resurrect a limited number of times. He couldn't head above the gray fog for confirmation, as he didn't know when or how his bodyguard would be watching him.

I should be firm about not heading to the Hornacis mountain range to seek out the Antigonus family's treasure... Heh heh, I have a feeling that I would say how nice it is in the future when I actually do it... (Just wanted to leave these thoughts here)

The last thing he did before falling asleep was deciding on his future plans aside from his advancement: *I should obtain mystical items that have less severe negative effects. Before my digestion and increase in strength, it's best to have more life-preservation abilities... Apart from this, investing, taking on jobs, saving up money, and attempts to look for Lanevus to use him as the starting point for my revenge, can also be considered a form of practice...*

The next morning, the newspapers were talking about the Intis ambassador's death, and how the Aurora Order claimed responsibility for it.

Chapter 254: Various Parties

Audrey was delighted by the news that the mission given by The Fool was completed so quickly, but she was also scared by Mr. A and the Aurora Order carrying out an assassination so easily. She became even more cautious of him and decided not to attend the Beyonder gathering he organized again.

In the Quelaag club, Klein got a room that was close to the one Doragu's mistress was staying in. As he was deliberating how he would sneak in and take a picture, Miss Bodyguard told him that she could help hide the camera's flash before she fused with the lens. Testing it, he found the flash to be much less obvious, and the picture quality was quite good.

Having made his preparations, Klein climbed out of his window and entered his target's room, deciding to hide in a cupboard. He made fun of himself before hearing the door to the room open.

Chapter 255: Photography Expert

He heard the two talk as Doragu gave the woman a present whose price was equal to Benson's salary, which he would use to provide his brother and sister with an education, feed them fairly well, and even provide them with a place to sleep. When they were distracted, Klein took that chance to push the cupboard door open and take out the camera, taking a few shots without being noticed.

After he was done, he stuck to the ground and moved around the furniture of the room whenever the two couldn't see him, quietly pulling the door open and entering the corridor. Closing the door in silence, he pressed a hand to his chest before bowing in his target's direction. Heading back to his lounge, he invited his bodyguard to eat in the cafeteria, but she quickly turned him down, saying that she could go without eating for two weeks. When she disappeared into a mirror, Klein was left curious about her sequence once again.

Observing himself in the bathroom mirror; his glasses, slight stubble, and hair parted to the side, Klein felt that he looked different enough that he wouldn't be recognized unless someone scrutinized his appearance. In the cafeteria, he met Aaron Ceres, and the two talked about the latest news for a while. The Civil Servant Examination was mentioned in passing, leaving Klein wondering how Benson's preparations had been going, and whether he would have been affected by his younger brother's death.

Their talk then led to Aaron mentioning how he had been strangely unlucky recently. Klein's thoughts? *Well, I can't help much... Well, actually, I know of a luck enhancement ritual, but its effect is to send you above a gray fog...* In the evening, he went back to the Bravehearts bar.

Chapter 256: Meeting the Apothecary Again

Having confirmed through Miss Bodyguard that he wasn't being monitored, Klein didn't know whether to feel honored that his act was so good that no one could guess he was the one behind the ambassador's assassination, or insulted at the military thinking that he didn't pose a threat and wasn't worth paying attention to.

Putting on the silver mask and dark robe, he was led to the same gathering he had attended before, with Miss bodyguard not being detected as she followed him. When they started, the Apothecary said

that the Beyonder who had accepted his mission last time (to kill some beasts who would eat his herbs) had died. Klein suggested getting the attention of the officials since the matter seemed to be too dangerous. Excerpt from the book:

[Eye of Wisdom applauded. “Such a great idea! We’re afraid of the official Beyonders, but similarly, we can make use of them. We don’t have to handle everything on our own.”

That’s because I was an official Beyonder, so my train of thought would definitely be different from pure savages like you... Klein smiled as he lampooned.]

(Side note: The word “lampoon” is a meme in the community, as it is used extensively even though none of us had ever heard of it prior to reading LOM. I had to google its meaning after noticing how often Klein “lampoons”)

For the rest of the gathering, Klein found nothing of interest and, in the end, was waiting for his turn to leave. While waiting, Eye of Wisdom recognized him as the one who bought the dangerous mystical item before, and Klein used that chance to imply that he had become a Beyonder. Having heard them, the Apothecary joined their conversation, mentioning his teacher and how he should have chosen a path that would make him lucky (i.e the Monster pathway) instead of concocting medicines. Talks of these pathways and a teacher made Klein confident that the man was part of the Life School of Thought.

Chapter 257: “2-081”

Klein promised the Apothecary that he would try to help him find the necessary ingredients to advance his sequence, but he wanted the Apothecary formula in exchange. The man refused, saying that he could only give it to a student (that seemed to be a rule the Life School of Thought had), but he could give him a hint to a place in Backlund where he could obtain that formula. Klein then asked if he could purchase a sedative that could treat mental illnesses, as Miss Bodyguard had previously expressed her concerns for Klein after his consciousness had come into contact with the True Creator.

The Apothecary agreed to provide him with four, and Eye of Wisdom informed him of the code they used to decide when and how to hold the gathering, so Klein would no longer have to rely on Kaspars. He then expressed his desire to purchase mystical items that would help him defend himself, to which Eye of Wisdom told him about 2-081. After explaining the official Beyonders’ naming conventions for Sealed Artifacts, he described its abilities: it allowed him to understand and comprehend many things, including a Beyonder’s powers, strengths, and weaknesses. It would also give him a chance at being able to mimic them, though the higher the level, the more likely he was to fail, with even success meaning that he would have an ability way weaker than the original.

Its negative effects were that it would put the wielder’s mind in a state of overdrive, and exceeding a time limit would turn him into a retard. After saying all of that, he told Klein that this item wasn’t for sale, he just wanted to flaunt his collection. Instead, he could sell him one of two items: the first was a brooch that could ward off spirits and purify them, while also allowing the wielder to use some spells from the Sun domain. The negative effect was that if would make the person carrying it feel unbearable heat that couldn’t be offset.

The second item was a hat that could change shapes; it would allow him to move freely underwater for at least half an hour and use some Water and Wind domain spells. Its negative effect was that it would make him constantly desire water, so walking on land would gradually weaken him. Klein told the elder that he would think about it and make his decision by the next gathering, also expressing his lack of money.

Chapter 258: Murder Case

On the way home, Miss Bodyguard appeared opposite Klein in the carriage, telling him that Eye of Wisdom had sensed her presence. Klein's guess was that the elder belonged to either the Church of Steam and Machinery or the Church of Knowledge and Wisdom, but he couldn't tell her that, as he was supposed to be someone who had only just entered the Beyonder world.

Sensing a strong smell of blood, the two looked out of the carriage window and into an alley. At the same time, a pedestrian was passing by before letting out a sudden scream, causing the carriage driver to slow down. In the alley, a woman was lying on the ground, her blood flowing, her internal organs seeming to have been hollowed out. As a former Nighthawk, Klein's first thought was of the Blood Sanctify Sect and their murders and strange rituals. The blond bodyguard guessed the same out loud before disappearing.

They controlled the Criminal pathway, and from Sequence 8, they start to lose their conscience and humanity, slowly turning more demonic. Klein's carriage had already passed the scene when the patrolling police started approaching, and this didn't involve him anyway, as he was no longer an official Beyonder. He was just an ordinary citizen passing by.

On Saturday morning, Klein went to the police station to retrieve the bail he had previously paid. As he was having lunch, his doorbell rang; it was an old-fashioned gentleman named Millet Carter who was looking for Detective Sherlock Moriarty. The man had just moved into Backlund and, while renovating the house he had just bought, found an underground structure. He stopped construction in case the situation wasn't safe and wanted to hire someone to investigate. When Klein suggested contacting the police, Millet Carter said that he didn't want too many people to know about this, especially the government.

Excusing himself to the bathroom, Klein couldn't take four steps counterclockwise, as he was still being watched by Miss Bodyguard. Instead, he performed a divination in the real world, getting the revelation that he should accept this commission. Asking for her opinion and getting the answer that the danger wasn't too great, he went back and accepted the job.

Chapter 259: Underground Structure

After signing the contract and making an advance payment, the gentleman left, as Sherlock Moriarty had told him that he would come by later in the afternoon. Finishing his lunch, Klein met up with Mrs. Mary as scheduled, giving her the picture he had chosen. After handing over the rest of the payment, the woman abruptly got up to leave before he could give a response. At the agreed time, Klein headed over to the house that once belonged to a viscount. He conversed with Millet for some time before being led to the secret door hidden in the basement.

Carrying a lantern, Klein walked in with Miss Bodyguard being his only companion. Pushing the main stone door open, many snakes started piling up in front of him, forming a giant nest of them. I'll let him describe his feelings himself:

[Although he was a man, he was still afraid of snakes. Snakes were the animal that he was most afraid of.

This stemmed from a psychological trauma in the past. When he was a child—despite being way past his bedtime—he liked to secretly open the door to his room and watch movies with his parents through a crack.

Unfortunately, his parents once watched a snake disaster movie. One scene involved the demolition of a building. The result was the unearthing of a large nest of snakes, and the dense squirming remained deeply imprinted in his mind.]

Witnessing his helplessness, Miss Bodyguard summoned a strong gust of wind that blew away the snakes, scaring them into slithering away and hiding. Entering the wide hall, Klein, a history graduate, noticed that the structure's architectural style seemed to belong to the Fourth Epoch.

Chapter 260: Strange Statues

The original Klein was very interested in the Fourth Epoch, so he had done a lot of relevant research. So, even now, he still remembered a lot of content about it. The most notable point about its fashion and architecture was the asymmetry, along with their frequent use of black. The design of this structure implied that it had once belonged to powerful aristocracy.

Going deeper, Klein encountered a platform that had two seats of equal status. This was an anomaly, as all of the known empires of the Fourth Epoch had a strict hierarchy, with only one person wielding the most power. Conversing with Miss Bodyguard, they came to the conclusion that the emblem on the back of one of the seats belonged to the Tudor family, though neither of them recognized the one behind the other seat.

To the side, there were seven doors. Klein started to go through them one by one, starting from the left. The first room had the symbol that he recognized as belonging to the Church of Evernight, and inside, there was a statue of a lady wearing a dress that seemed to be adorned in stars. He had once been told by Dunn that the difference between evil being and orthodox ones was the former's use of their statues in the shape of humanoid beings, while the latter only used symbols and emblems. What he was seeing deeply shook that belief.

Of course, he couldn't fully rely on his captain's guess; he was only a Sequence 7 at the time, and he wasn't a high-ranking member of the church. Though he also couldn't ignore the possibility that the Tudors were deliberately being blasphemous, and may have been setting up a strange ritual. Taking a moment to recompose himself, he left with Miss Bodyguard to check the other doors.

Chapter 261: The Innermost Room

The following five rooms also had emblems on the doors and statues in the room, they seemed to represent: Earth Mother, Storms, The Sun, Combat, and Knowledge and Wisdom. As Steam and Machinery was relatively young and wasn't that powerful before Roselle's appearance, it made sense for him to not be included. Though how and why these six statues could co-exist, despite their owners' strong dislike for each other, still eluded him.

Standing before the final door, Klein was warned by Miss Bodyguard that what lay ahead was very dangerous, but it was subdued, and that he shouldn't touch anything while inside. He guessed that her words meant there something sealed inside. The two walked in for a while, encountering a door to the side that was completely collapsed, before finding another that showed a small gap he could look through.

Inside, he could see a pile of Beyonder characteristics and mystical items, along with a double door that seemed to be covered in fresh blood. His body started showing and abnormality, and Miss Bodyguard suddenly seemed to have a shadow, even though she never used to have one. Their best choice was to run as fast as they could. As soon as they did, a dark shadow started following them, ingulfing everything it could touch.

As soon as they were back in the wide hall, everything seemed to return to normal. Miss Bodyguard clarified that what they encountered was an evil spirit; this was the most powerful type of spirit-like monsters, some of them were even as powerful as High-Sequence Beyonders.

Chapter 262: Dream

One needs to be aware of one's strength. I cannot be enticed by the suspected Beyonder characteristics and mystical items left in there... Greed often leads to death...

Klein, being a cautious mc, made the logical and correct decision of not insisting on this exploration. He wanted to make Millet Carter call the police, but he couldn't divulge much information about the structure, which would cause heavy casualties, possibly even helping the evil spirit escape. Remembering the characteristics in the room, he guessed that those were people who had lost their lives while exploring this place. So, he decided to first do some research and seek out the descendants of the viscount family who had lived here. After gathering enough information, he would either: get some explosives and bury this place, or send an anonymous letter to the police detailing the existence of the evil spirit.

["You still have some sense," she commented calmly, then drifted toward the exit of the ancient hall.

Other than being suspected to be under the True Creator's influence, in what way do I look like a madman? Klein silently lampooned.]

[Millet Carter was pacing about in the basement. When he saw Klein exit, he hurriedly asked, "How is it? What's the situation inside?"

Klein had long thought of an excuse as he said with an expression of fear, "Terrible, there are a lot of snakes in there, and many spots have collapsed. I plan to gather some information, gather some

manpower, and once preparations are done, do another round of exploration. During this period of time, it's best that you don't send anyone in. Believe me, there are more venomous snakes in there than you can imagine."

Millet drew a gasp and asked in fear, "Will they slither out? Do you know any experts that can deal with the snakes?"

Klein immediately nodded. "I'll get people to help and try my best to deal with this matter. It's the cold autumn now, and the snakes aren't willing to move. As long as you don't send anyone to disturb them, nothing will happen."] (Just wanted to show Klein's convincing lying skills)

Millet Carter told him that this house once belonged to someone named Viscount Pound who had gained his title in the Battle of the Violated Oath. Decades later, his family started losing heirs and had to seek out distant relatives for the inheritance, with the newest Viscount Pound squandering most of the family's wealth and being on the verge of bankruptcy.

The Battle of the Violated Oath was a war over faith and religion that took place 738 years ago between the large countries of the Northern Continent, resulting in smaller countries gaining their independence. After that, the continent spent some relatively peaceful centuries until Roselle's time.

In the evening, Klein was peacefully asleep when he suddenly became lucid, implying that someone was invading his dream. In the new dream, he found himself in a battlefield, with a giant knight fighting an ancient dragon. The scene changed, showing him the bloody door he had seen in the underground structure. The door opened a crack, allowing him to see a someone sitting on a high-back chair: the knight from the previous scene. The man suddenly raised his head, his decaying face and emotionless eyes jolting Klein awake.

Chapter 263: Spiritual Perception and Attempt

When he told Miss Bodyguard of his dream, she claimed that it was just the influence of the evil spirit's aura, and that it would gradually weaken and disappear. In the morning, Klein was reading the newspapers when he saw the latest developments with the Civil Servant Examination. This made him think of Benson, but he also found it strange how the King seemed to be in a rush to make the change.

Back in Tingen, the Morettis found out about the construction of a University of Technology in Backlund. Melissa tried making a lot of excuses but, in the end, her brother was able to convince her that the two of them should move to the capital. She could become a university student, and he could become a civil servant.

During the whole of Sunday, Klein busied himself browsing books and essays in multiple libraries, annoyed that he didn't just have a "search" function. When he got home, he ended his contract with Miss Bodyguard, promising to contact her through Maric if he found any clues about the Pound family. Still not relaxing, it was only late into the night that he got the iron box and touched Rosago's black eye. Resisting the ravings, he only saw his own threads, meaning that he was the only person around.

Taking everything with him above the gray fog, he found that he couldn't use its power to separate the characteristic from the madness within it. Following that, he once again attempted to create a puppet as an additional member of the Tarot Club (he had wanted to do that in Volume 1 so that the puppet could

ask questions that were inconvenient for The Fool to ask). But, just like his first attempt, it was too stiff and lifeless, he wouldn't be able to deceive the members into believing that this was a real person. However, he had an idea.

Touching the Marionettist Beyonder characteristic, Klein could see that the fake person also had black threads floating out from his body. Spreading out his spirituality, he grasped those threads and, with a thought, was able to control the body sitting opposite him. He could feel how draining maintaining this fake member was, so, he couldn't try to conjure a second one.

[Klein happily practiced, over and over again, even learning how to manipulate his clone's throat and mouth to let him speak. When his spirituality was almost exhausted, he smiled and said to the fake person in front of him, "Welcome, new member. Which tarot card do you wish to draw?"

After saying that, he closed his mouth. The fake person opposite him lifted his hand to stroke his chin as he laughed hoarsely, "World! I choose the card 'The World.'"]

Chapter 264: A Five-Person Gathering

As "The Fool" was the beginning of the tarot, Klein named his puppet after the last card: "The World", completing a perfect cycle. After returning to the real world, he slept for a while before busying himself in the libraries once more. When it was almost time for the weekly gathering, he headed back above the gray fog and conjured the fake World on the opposite end of the table before warning The Sun that they were about to start.

At three in the afternoon, the three members' silhouettes were projected at their respective seats. Klein introduced the new member, informing Audrey that he wanted her to entrust a task to the friends she had nominated, as part of their examination. He wanted them to investigate a person, whose portrait he showed her; it was Lanevus (the swindler from Volume 1 who was the reason for the existence of the child in the final battle. He was one of the two people Klein wanted to have his revenge on, alongside Ince Zangwill, the guy who directly killed Klein and orchestrated most of the events of that volume).

Alger then gave another six pages of Roselle's diary, promising to give the final page in the following gathering. In the first page, the emperor had written about his three children, with Zaratul giving him hints about their future: for the youngest, he only smiled. For the eldest son, Ciel, death was inevitable, but that may be a good thing. And for the eldest daughter, Bernadette, she would come to hate her father and turn her back on him, and she would become an important figure in the mysterious world. Roselle believed that the Seer, who wasn't on the Monster pathway, must have been mistaken.

Chapter 265: Cards of Blasphemy

The second page talked about the Sauron family and its history spanning more than 2000 years, as he had met one of its descendants. This long history made Klein think of bringing them up later to see whether The Sun had any knowledge of them or whether they only rose in power after The Cataclysm. The third page detailed some of Roselle's actions that helped him reconcile with the churches in Intis, which would later help with his ascension to the position of emperor. But that only made his assassination stranger.

The fourth page had Roselle confused by someone who was very proud at resembling an ancestor of his, and he wondered whether “talent” or “physical resemblance” could affect a Beyonder’s powers and digestion. Klein’s guess was that, since a High-Sequence Beyonder’s characteristic contained their mental imprint and spiritual mark, people who resembled the original owner could avoid its negative influence more than others. But this would still not lessen the acting methods importance, as acting was still necessary to fully digest the characteristics.

The fifth page was after Roselle had participated in another gathering with that “most ancient organization”. He learned that they believed an unavoidable doomsday was coming, and that information could purify and help them face it. They believed in the original Creator and that he would re-awaken to create a new world once this one ended. They wielded the second Blasphemy Slate, but they only allowed their members to choose between a few pathways: Bard, Sailor, Reader, and Spectator.

(The two Blasphemy Slates were only barely mentioned in the donghua. They are said to contain the details of the 22 pathways, with little being known about what the differences between the two slates is. Roselle had supposedly created the popular tarot after having seen one of them.)

This information was similar to Klein’s guess that the Bard, Sailor, Reader, and Secrets Suppliants pathways were exchangeable at Sequence 4, with Manipulator most likely being one of the high sequences of the Spectator pathway. He also found it strange how so many secret organizations believed in the apocalypse, and he was annoyed at how Roselle never wrote down the name of the organization he was part of.

On the last page, the emperor wrote down his creation on the Cards of Blasphemy, which would number 22, corresponding to the pathways, with some names corresponding to the tarot Major Arcana, while others would have to be changed to match the original potions. These cards possessed characteristics of anti-divination and anti-prophecy, and they would have an activation incantation so that only his children or “fated ones” could use them. He also noted down his shock after seeing the Blasphemy Slate, as the pathways didn’t end at Sequence 1.

For every pathway, there was a Sequence 0 potion and ritual, making one the deity presiding over that pathway. For example, Sequence 0: Sun.

Chapter 266: The World’s Commission

Klein barely maintained his composure in front of the gathering’s members. He thought back to how Roselle had regretted not choosing Seer, Apprentice, or Marauder, and guessed that it may have been because their corresponding Sequence 0s were unoccupied. He became even more worried about what the emperor had been plotting near the end of his days, to get the whole world to become his enemy. But he couldn’t think about this for too long; otherwise, the others would start to notice.

Dismissing the last page, The Fool commended Justice for having finished off Bakerland in less than a week, making her delighted at The Hanged Man’s obvious astonishment. She refused payment, saying that she already owed The Fool’s blessed some of Qilangos’ bounty, and that she would send him the rest of that money when it wouldn’t incur her parents’ suspicion.

When that was over, The World asked for permission to speak. Audrey, who had been paying attention to this new member, noticed that he didn't seem surprised at the ambassador's death. That implied that he either didn't understand its significance, or he was someone who could greatly control his reactions and maintain his composure. She also noticed that the movement of his mouth didn't match his words, so she guessed that The Fool was translating his words to them just as he did with The Sun. That prevented her from trying to read him through his speech.

Klein, through The World, asked about some of the ingredients he needed, while also adding among them the ingredient that the Apothecary needed so that no one could guess his sequence. The Sun said that he could provide him with two of them and, in exchange, he wanted a weapon that would suit him. Audrey and Alger – who weren't very trusting of the new, unreadable member – warned Derrick of the approximate price of the ingredients he would collect, so that The World wouldn't get him a weapon that was of a lower value. This made things very difficult for Klein, as he didn't know what the City of Silver's currency was, and could only translate the price to the boy in terms of Sequence 9 potion formulas.

Audrey then promised to look for the remaining two ingredients he needed, hoping to exchange them for the Spectator's Sequence 7 Psychiatrist formula and ingredients. Alger said the same, with his price being the Sailor pathway's Sequence 6 Wind-blessed. He knew that would be more expensive than both ingredients combined, so he told The World that he could think of whatever else he needed to make up for the difference. Klein found it weird that a member of the Church of Storms was seeking the formula elsewhere, so he guesses that The Hanged Man must have wanted to hide just how fast he was digesting his Seafarer potion.

Chapter 267: Singing to the Same Tune

The World's second request was to get information about all the abject nobles in their kingdom, including their current addresses. He didn't directly mention the current Baronet Pound so that no one could connect him to Sherlock Moriarty's investigations.

[Audrey stared blankly upon hearing that. She once again examined the member at the end of the long bronze table and probed, "What do you want to do?"

The World laughed with a hoarse voice. "That's not something you need to worry about. I'm only searching for some things. I won't do them any harm. I can swear on this point and allow Mr. Fool to bear witness."]

Audrey, who was frustrated at how good The World was at controlling his body language, said that her knowledge wasn't sufficient, so she would need a few days to investigate more. In return, she wanted to know more about the other Beyonder pathways. For that, she requested a private audience with him from The Fool, who agreed and isolated Alger and Derrick's senses.

He told her about the Demoness pathway (why he chose that one is beyond me): its Sequence 7 and what it could do to a person; their powers in spreading calamity, diseases and pain; and the higher sequences' control over silk threads. He said that this information should make it easier for her to identify a demoness.

[Her mind whirled quickly, and she immediately had a new question. “If, and I’m saying if—an animal consumes the Witch formula without dying or losing control, would the enhancement of its charms be more suited to human tastes, or focused on charms for its own species? For example, a female cat which makes all male cats and all cat lovers become fanatical towards it?”

The World was momentarily unsure how to respond. After a few seconds, he said, “I’ve never studied such matters.”] (I was not going to suffer from this question on my own, you have to suffer with me)

Once she was satisfied with the information and their private exchange was over, the newcomer announced his third request: he wanted to know whether the Sauron family in Intis still had any High-Sequence Beyonders. The Sun’s lack of reaction implied that he had never heard of them, which was all Klein wanted to check. So, The Fool said that he would answer the question, isolating the other members’ senses as he stared at his puppet for a few seconds.

[After the private exchange, Klein deliberately made The World bow and say in a hoarse voice, “Honorable Mr. Fool, thank you for your answer; it was very helpful to me.”

“This is an equivalent exchange; there’s no need to thank me.” Klein endured the goosebumps that suddenly surfaced on his skin as he answered indifferently.] (Spoiler Alert: This will not be the last time he feels awkward about praising or thanking himself)

The gathering’s open communication segment didn’t last long and, when they were done, Klein didn’t linger above the gray fog, as his spirituality was already greatly expended. After getting some rest, he decided to head to a cemetery to test the influence of Azik’s copper whistle.

[Of course, the experiment would only be carried out after dark. The reason why he was heading out now was that it would be very strange and very eye-catching to hire a carriage to visit a cemetery in the evening.]